FEDEX | FDE TRAINING PROGRAM

EverMind: proposal benchmark review

proposal.md and architecture.png, checked against the four course guides

Reviewed	openspec/changes/add-evermind-pipeline/proposal.md; docs/architecture.png
Benchmarked against	WA3922-CAP, WA3915, AIC-2101, AIC-1102 (lesson + lab guides)
Outcome	Both rewritten. Old versions in backup/2026-10-15-pre-benchmark/
Length	196 to 185 lines - did not grow
Date	15 October 2026

The one thing that matters

The capstone lab guide says this outright, in a note in the Phase 2 escalation section:

> **From the WA3922-CAP lab guide.** "One LlmAgent can call tools and emit an output_schema at the same time. In ADK 2.x the agent runs its tools during its reasoning and enforces the schema on its final answer... (ADK 1.x couldn't do this and forced you to split the work across two agents joined by a SequentialAgent.) Reach for a workflow only when you have genuinely separate steps, not to work around a limit that's gone. Both samples below are single agents."

Our diagram drew a three-agent SequentialAgent, and justified it by exactly that limit. We had designed around a constraint the course says was removed - and the lab names the workaround we had reinvented.

The WA3915 note behind our reasoning is real: "Combining output_schema with tools is limited. Only some models support both at once." Both statements are true. The pairing is model-dependent, which makes it a contingency to plan for, not a topology to commit to before the gate.

The diagram now shows one agent. The split appears as a small dashed panel labelled "CONTINGENCY, NOT THE DESIGN" - planned, visibly not promised.

What else was missing

The rubric was never referenced

The WA3922-CAP lesson guide lists six numbered success criteria and says: "Agree on these with your instructor at the approval gate. They are your rubric." The proposal never mentioned them. The sign-off block now does, and names the six evaluation cases as the evidence for criterion 5.

The architectural answers were generic

The lab lists the exact questions the instructor asks under each concern. Several went unanswered:

What the lab says the instructor asks	Before	Now
How do you prevent unnecessary tool access?	not addressed	Three read-only functions; no write function implemented or imported anywhere.
When a tool call fails, how does the agent degrade instead of crashing?	not addressed	Fails closed - the candidate is queued as a refusal rather than crashing the batch.
How will you know it is giving valuable responses in production?	not addressed	Reviewer accept and reject rates are the production quality signal.

What the lab says the instructor asks	Before	Now
Is the whole environment recreatable from code?	not addressed	Rebuilds from the committed fixture generator; recovery is re-running the batch.
Container, virtual machine, or serverless?	“Agent Engine”	A scheduled job, with the reason: no request path and no scaling pressure.

Two requirements we met but never named

- **The answer key.** The lab says to keep the expected results “in a separate file the agent never reads”. We had exactly that in the labelled query log, and never used the words. Now stated explicitly - it is what turns the eval set from impression into evidence.
- **The failure path.** Phase 3 requires one, and it is the most repeated requirement in the capstone materials. It was a table row like any other. It is now called out as the case that matters: the agent declines rather than invents.

What the two files look like now

proposal.md. Problem (with why an agent, not one model call) - Solution (inputs, decisions, output shape) - Scope - The demonstration data - Risks, guards and the eval case that proves each - Build sketch with honest sizing - How we will prove it works - The six architectural considerations - Team - Backup idea - Sign-off.

architecture.png. Fixtures, then grouping, then one LlmAgent with three read-only tools, then the output schema with the cite-or-reject rule, then a risk-to-guard band, then human approval. The escalation contingency sits bottom-left, deliberately quiet.

Three visual bugs were fixed while redrawing: “Pydantic” was misspelled, an arrow ran through its own caption, and a caption collided with the escalation box.

One judgement call to check

The handout asks for one to two pages. The proposal is about four printed. I kept it that way deliberately: the six architectural answers alone are a page, and the lab’s own sample projects are worked out in comparable depth.

If the instructor is strict on length, the architecture table moves to design.md with a one-line pointer left behind. That lands the proposal at two pages and takes a minute.

Not touched

design.md, tasks.md and the four delta specs were left alone, as asked. They still treat the agent topology as an open question, which is now consistent with the proposal and the drawing rather than contradicting them.

The short version. The proposal was already well written. What it got wrong was benchmarking: it planned around an ADK limit the capstone says is gone, it never referenced the rubric it will be marked against, and it answered the architecture questions in general terms rather than the specific ones the instructor is given to ask. All three are now fixed, and the document is shorter than before.